SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #71 · RESURRECTION & THE BODY

“My body doesn’t matter to God; only my soul counts.”

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Where it often comes from

Teaching that focused only on “saving souls.” Ideas that the body is a prison and the spirit is what really matters. Neglecting health, rest, or care because it seemed unspiritual. Shame about the body. Seeing physical needs as less important than spiritual ones.

What Scripture teaches

God cares about the whole person: spirit, soul, and body. Paul prayed that believers would be kept blameless in spirit, soul, and body. Your body is a temple of the Holy Spirit, and you are called to offer it to God as a living sacrifice. Jesus rose bodily from the dead, and God promises to give life to your mortal body and transform it to be like Christ’s glorious body. Your body matters to God now and forever.

> *“Now may the God of peace Himself sanctify you completely, and may your entire spirit, soul, and body be kept blameless at the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ”* **(1 Thessalonians 5:23)**.

Also see

> “Therefore I urge you, brothers, on account of God’s mercy, to offer your bodies as living sacrifices, holy and pleasing to God, which is your spiritual service of worship” **(Romans 12:1)**.

> “Do you not know that your body is a temple of the Holy Spirit who is in you, whom you have received from God? You are not your own; you were bought at a price. Therefore glorify God with your body” **(1 Corinthians 6:19–20)**.

> “And if the Spirit of Him who raised Jesus from the dead is living in you, He who raised Christ Jesus from the dead will also give life to your mortal bodies through His Spirit, who lives in you” **(Romans 8:11)**.

> “But our citizenship is in heaven, and we eagerly await a Savior from there, the Lord Jesus Christ, who, by the power that enables Him to subject all things to Himself, will transform our lowly bodies to be like His glorious body” **(Philippians 3:20–21)**.

Common self-statements

- Only my soul matters to God.
- Taking care of my body is unspiritual.
- My body is just a shell.
- It doesn’t matter how I treat my body.
- God only cares about spiritual things.
- My physical needs aren’t important.

Common logical errors

- **All-or-nothing thinking:** Separating body and soul as if only one matters.
- **Discounting:** Treating physical care as unimportant to faith.
- **Mental filter:** Overlooking God’s plan to raise and transform the body.

- **Neglect:** Ignoring rest, health, or care in the name of spirituality.

Challenging questions

- Why did Paul pray for spirit, soul, and body?
- What does it mean that my body is a temple of the Holy Spirit?
- Did Jesus rise with a body or only as a spirit?
- What does God promise to do with my mortal body?
- How might I honor God with my body this week?
- Who taught me that the body doesn't matter?
- What physical need have I been neglecting?

Truth summary

> My body matters to God. He cares about my whole person: spirit, soul, and body. My body is a temple of the Holy Spirit, and I can offer it to God as a living sacrifice. One day God will raise and transform my body to be like Christ's glorious body. I can care for my body as an act of worship.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Sickness
- God, Creator
- Eternal Life
- Christ, Resurrection of
- Worship

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "My body doesn't matter to God; only my soul counts"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My body doesn't matter to God; only my soul counts." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Why did Paul pray for body as well as spirit?
- ☐ What does it mean that my body is a temple?
- ☐ Did Jesus rise with a body?
- ☐ What will God do with my mortal body?
- ☐ How can I honor God with my body?
- ☐ What physical need have I neglected?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God cares about my whole person.
- ☐ My body is a temple of the Holy Spirit.
- ☐ I can offer my body to God as worship.
- ☐ God will give life to my mortal body.
- ☐ Jesus will transform my body to be like His.
- ☐ Caring for my body can honor God.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **1 Thessalonians 5:23**
  "Now may the God of peace Himself sanctify you completely, and may your entire spirit, soul, and body be kept blameless at the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ."
- [ ] **Romans 12:1**
  "Therefore I urge you, brothers, on account of God's mercy, to offer your bodies as living sacrifices, holy and pleasing to God, which is your spiritual service of worship."
- [ ] **1 Corinthians 6:19–20**
  "Do you not know that your body is a temple of the Holy Spirit who is in you, whom you have received from God? You are not your own; you were bought at a price. Therefore glorify God with your body."
- [ ] **Romans 8:11**
  "And if the Spirit of Him who raised Jesus from the dead is living in you, He who raised Christ Jesus from the dead will also give life to your mortal bodies through His Spirit, who lives in you."
- [ ] **Philippians 3:20–21**
  "But our citizenship is in heaven, and we eagerly await a Savior from there, the Lord Jesus Christ, who, by the power that enables Him to subject all things to Himself, will transform our lowly bodies to be like His glorious body."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Body care log:** Each day, write one way I cared for my body as an act of worship.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, 1 Thessalonians 5:23 becomes: "Now may the God of peace Himself sanctify **Sarah** completely, and may **her** entire spirit, soul, and body be kept blameless at the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "God, Creator" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Depression audio download.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Choose one healthy habit for this week,** such as sleep, a walk, or a healthy meal, and offer it to God.
- ☐ **Read 1 Corinthians 15:35–58,** and write what God promises for the body.
- ☐ **Schedule a needed medical or dental appointment** you've been putting off.
- ☐ **Thank God for one part of your body each day** this week.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My body doesn't matter to God; only my soul counts": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One way I cared for my body
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My body doesn't matter to God; only my soul counts.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, thank You that You care about my whole person, body included. Help me reject the lie that only my soul counts. Teach me to honor You with my body, to care for it wisely, and to look forward to the day You will raise and transform it. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.